

handheld video game market a monopoly.

The next 'generation' of consoles emerged in the period 1998 to 2001, with graphics becoming the point of contention as multimedia playback increasingly gained ground.

The struggling Sega gave it one last shot with the DreamCast, and subsequently withdrew from the console market for good.

Nintendo's loss in the last battle due to the cartridge format saw the company release its first disk-based console, the GameCube. The graphics and processing power, however, never competed with Sony's PlayStation 2, and the latter started a period of rule that was to last for many years.

The PlayStation 2, released in 2000, went on to become the most widely sold video game console of all time, racking up 132 million sales, so far.

The next year, Microsoft decided to throw its hat into the ring with its first hardware venture, the Xbox. Based on Intel's Pentium III CPU, the console used much PC technology to leverage its internal development.



Gameboy Color



The DreamCast was Sega's last chance of survival